a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 02

The 4 Pedagogy Moves

Concrete-before-abstract. Evidence-not-assumptions. Measurable outcomes. Capstone arc.

The operating system every Cash lesson is built on - and the four-box checklist a teacher pastes inside the front of every plan book.

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> If a lesson plan doesn't tick all four, it's incomplete. Fix it before Monday.

Module length: ~20 minutes **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 3 (Concrete-First Rewrite), Activity 4 (Outcome-Verb Audit) **Walkaway move:** a four-box lesson-prep checklist you can paste into the front of every plan book.

Why these four

The four pedagogy moves are not a clever framework I invented for the PD. They are the working architecture of the curriculum. Every Cash lesson is built on them. Every Capstone Checkpoint is graded by them. Every misconception table corrects against them. If you walk away from this PD with nothing else, walk away with these four.

The four moves:

1. **Concrete before abstract.**
2. **Evidence not assumptions.**
3. **Measurable strand outcomes.**
4. **Capstone arc.**

You can hold all four in one breath. You should be able to hold them in one breath by the end of this module.

Move 1 — Concrete before abstract

WHAT IT MEANS

Every concept enters the classroom through a specific person, a specific number, or a specific story before it becomes a definition. The abstract — the term, the rule, the formula — comes second. The Cash to Company architecture refuses to lead with definitions.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

In a typical curriculum, "contribution margin" is introduced in Grade 7 with a definition: "Contribution margin is the amount each unit sold contributes to covering fixed costs." That sentence is true and useless. A 7th-grader hears it as a sequence of words.

In Cash to Company, contribution margin enters through a worked story. "Imagine a kid named Mae who sells friendship bracelets at lunch for $3. Each bracelet uses 90 cents of string and beads. So Mae keeps $2.10 from every bracelet. That $2.10 is what's left to pay everything else — the table she paid to use, the materials she ran out of and replaced, the time it took her to set up. We call that $2.10 her contribution margin — what each sale 'contributes' after the cost of making the thing itself."

The rule comes after the story. The story is the carrier.

WHY IT WORKS

Three reasons:

1. Working memory. A definition is a string of unfamiliar words. A story is a single image. Working memory holds the image; it dumps the string of words.

2. Equity. A student whose home language is not English, or whose vocabulary in the domain is thinner, can hold the story even when the term is foreign. By the time the term arrives, the student already understands the concept.

3. Honest pacing. Abstraction is the output of repeated concrete experience, not the input. A K-2 student learns "make versus do" by sorting twenty pictures, not by hearing "the difference between goods and services is..."

WHAT IT DOES NOT MEAN

- It does NOT mean "lots of pictures." Pictures help, but a picture is not concrete unless it represents a specific, named, particular thing. "A worker" is not concrete. "Mr. Diaz, who plows the snow on Locust Street" is concrete.
- It does NOT mean "no vocabulary." Vocabulary lands in every grade. The vocabulary roadmap in each Curriculum Book is intentional. The rule is concept-first, term-second, not "skip the term."
- It does NOT mean "anti-rigor." Cash to Company is rigorous. The rigor is hidden in the patient pacing of concrete-then-abstract, not in early-loading definitions.

LESSON-PREP TEST

Before you teach any Cash lesson, ask: "What is the specific person, specific number, or specific story that enters this concept first?" If you can't name one, the lesson plan as written has skipped a concrete and you need to add one. (The Curriculum Book usually names one. Don't replace it with your own definition-first opener.)

Move 2 — Evidence not assumptions

WHAT IT MEANS

The spine question — "which people, and how do you know?" — is not just Cash's catchphrase. It is the operational rule for every classroom claim. Every time a student says something about a customer, a price, a market, a need, a behavior, the teacher's job is to ask: which people, and how do you know?

The student's job, eventually, is to ask themselves and each other.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

Student says: "My friends will buy it." Teacher: "Which friends, and how do you know?" Student: "Well, I think they would." Teacher: "Right. That's an assumption. What would turn it into

evidence?" Student: "...ask them?" Teacher: "Ask them. Quote them. Write down what they actually said."

That whole exchange is sixty seconds. It is the single most repeated move in the program. By Grade 9 the student is doing it without prompting. By Grade 12 the student is asking other students.

WHY IT WORKS

A young entrepreneur fails on Day 1 because they assumed a customer wanted something the customer didn't want. A grown-up entrepreneur fails for the same reason. The skill of "checking the assumption" is the most transferable skill in business — and one of the most transferable skills in life. It is a metacognitive habit that pays out in every domain: science, history, friendship, debate, journalism, voting.

The spine question is also the program's primary anti-hustle vaccine. Every hustle-bro claim collapses on contact with the question. "Anyone can be rich!" — which people, and how do you know? "Just believe in yourself!" — which people did that work for, and how did you measure?

WHAT IT DOES NOT MEAN

- It does NOT mean "every student claim is wrong until proven." Many claims will turn out right. The point is not skepticism for its own sake; the point is the habit of checking.
- It does NOT mean "the teacher is the truth-checker." The teacher's job is to redirect to evidence, not to adjudicate the claim. The student is the truth-checker. The teacher is the prompter.
- It does NOT mean "ban opinions." Opinions are fine. Cash teaches students to label opinions as opinions and claims as claims. "I think purple bracelets will sell more" — fine, opinion. "Purple bracelets are most popular" — claim, where's the evidence?

LESSON-PREP TEST

Before you teach: "Where in this lesson does a student make a claim about a customer, a market, or a number? At each of those moments, am I prompted to ask 'which people, and how do you know?' If not, where do I add the prompt?"

Move 3 — Measurable strand outcomes

WHAT IT MEANS

Every Cash to Company lesson lands on something a student can demonstrably do — not understand, not appreciate, not be aware of. The verbs in the strand outcomes are intentionally observable: sort, name, list, identify, calculate, interview, write, present, defend.

This is the program's quiet revolution against fuzzy "understanding" objectives. "Students will understand the importance of customer feedback" is not a Cash to Company outcome.

"Students will conduct a 5-minute customer interview using three open-ended questions and produce a 1-paragraph summary of what the customer actually said" is.

THE 8 STRANDS AND THEIR VERBS

Strand	What students DO
BAVC Business Awareness & Value Creation	identify, name, sort, classify
PSIG Problem Solving & Idea Generation	brainstorm, prototype, test, revise
MFL Money & Financial Literacy	calculate, compare, budget, project
CBM Customers, Branding, Marketing	interview, segment, personify, write
OSO Operations, Systems, Organization	schedule, allocate, document, track
LTO Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	facilitate, distribute, decide, debrief
ESL Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	flag, comply, disclose, escalate
LRCI Launch Readiness & Continuous Improvement	pilot, measure, iterate, defend

Notice that none of those verbs are "understand," "appreciate," "be aware of," "know." Those are not measurable. Cash refuses them.

WHY IT WORKS

A measurable outcome is a fair outcome. A teacher can grade it. A student can self-assess against it. A parent can recognize it in the artifact a kid brings home. A foundation can audit it. A district can defend it on a board agenda.

Fuzzy outcomes — "students will love entrepreneurship," "students will feel empowered" — have a cost that compounds: they are not gradeable, they are not auditable, and they often mean the program is doing its actual work in the dark.

WHAT IT DOES NOT MEAN

- It does NOT mean "no affective work." Cash absolutely cares about how a student feels in the room. The affective work is real and is held in the classroom routines (Showcase + Stuck, the journal, the conferring). It is just not the outcome.
- It does NOT mean "rigid." A measurable outcome admits of many demonstrations. A 5-minute customer interview can be conducted in English, in Spanish, in ASL, in writing, with a parent, with a partner, with the teacher. The verb is the same.
- It does NOT mean "high-stakes assessment everywhere." Most strand outcomes are demonstrated formatively, in journals and conferring, not on big tests.

LESSON-PREP TEST

Before you teach: "At the end of this lesson, can I name an artifact a student produces? Can I score that artifact against a Rubric Bank rubric? If I asked a substitute teacher to score it, would they score it within one rubric step of me?"

Move 4 — Capstone arc

WHAT IT MEANS

Every grade has one Capstone — a year-long project the student designs, develops, refines, and defends. The Capstone has four Checkpoints (one per unit) and one Final Defense. Each Checkpoint is rubric-graded against a Rubric Bank rubric. Each defense is grade-band appropriate but holds the same architecture across the K-12 program.

Cash to Company is not a sequence of disconnected lessons. It is a year of Capstone work, with lessons that fuel it. The Capstone is the spine; the lessons are the ribs.

WHAT THE CAPSTONE LOOKS LIKE, K TO 12

Grade	Capstone	What students defend
K	Cash's Cafe	A pretend cafe with three jobs and three customers
1	The Make/Do Sort + Classroom Store	A poster + a 1-day store with one product and a sign
2	The Problem Wall + a Solution	A problem they identified and a solution they drew
3	The Skill-Hobby-Need Idea Pitch	One idea, drawn from their actual life
4	The 1-Page Plan	A simple plan with customer, product, price, place
5	The Market Day Stall	A real or simulated stall with a real product and a real price
6	The System Map	An operations diagram for a venture they design
7	The Customer-First Venture	A persona-driven venture with contribution margin and a 1-week feedback loop
8	The Improvement Audit	A real (small) operation they measure, change, and remeasure
9	The Premortem	A venture defended against its own most-likely failure modes
10	The Compliance & Capital Stack	An ownership structure, capital plan, and compliance checklist
11	The Sales Sprint	A real customer-facing pilot with show-don't-sell artifacts

Grade	Capstone	What students defend
12	The Launch Defense	A launch-ready plan defended to a panel of family + community judges

The architecture is consistent across grades: identify → develop → refine → defend. The complexity scales; the architecture does not change.

WHY IT WORKS

A Capstone arc gives every kid a year-long throughline. It gives every parent a recognizable artifact at the dinner table ("how's your bracelet business going?" / "tell me about your premortem"). It gives every teacher a structure that survives a missed week. It gives every administrator a defensible portfolio for state reporting.

It also matches how entrepreneurship actually works in real life. Real ventures are long games. The arc teaches the skill of staying with a project across months — not just executing a unit and forgetting.

WHAT IT DOES NOT MEAN

- It does NOT mean "every kid starts a business." Many ventures are simulated. Many are not money-making. The Capstone is a thinking exercise; the venture is the vehicle.
- It does NOT mean "K students are running real markets." K-2 Capstones are play-based. The program does not push K-2 students into real-money work. (See `_master/REAL_VENTURE_READINESS_CHECKLIST.md` for when real-money work is appropriate — Grade 11+, with explicit guardrails.)
- It does NOT mean "high-stakes only." The Capstone is graded along the way; the Final Defense is the celebration, not a gauntlet. The four Checkpoints carry the bulk of the assessment weight.

LESSON-PREP TEST

Before you teach: "Where does this lesson contribute to the Capstone? If a parent asked a student 'how is your Capstone coming along?' on the day of this lesson, what would change in the answer?"

The four-move lesson-prep checklist (paste into your plan book)

Print this. Tape it inside the front cover of your plan book.

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☐ CONCRETE FIRST: Named the specific person, number, or story that
  carries the concept before the term arrives.

☐ EVIDENCE PROMPT: Identified at least one moment where I will ask
  "which people, and how do you know?"

☐ MEASURABLE OUTCOME: Named the artifact a student produces and the
  Rubric Bank rubric I'll score it against.

☐ CAPSTONE LINK: Named what changes in the student's Capstone work
  because of this lesson.
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If a lesson plan doesn't tick all four, the plan is incomplete. Fix it before Monday.

Module 02 knowledge check

1. Restate Move 1 in one sentence.
2. The spine question is a tactic for which Move?
3. Name one fuzzy verb that Cash refuses, and one measurable verb that Cash uses instead.
4. How many Capstone Checkpoints are there per grade-year? How many Final Defenses?

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 3 (Concrete-First Rewrite):** Take a textbook financial-literacy lesson opener (one provided in the Activity Packet) and rewrite it concrete-first. Compare to the Cash to Company version.
- **Activity 4 (Outcome-Verb Audit):** Pick three lessons from a Cash Lesson Plans file. Underline the outcome verbs. Are they all measurable? If any are fuzzy, rewrite.

Module 02 — answers to the knowledge check

1. Every concept enters through a specific person, number, or story before it becomes a definition.
2. Move 2 — Evidence not assumptions.
3. Fuzzy: understand / appreciate / be aware of / know. Measurable (any): sort, name, calculate, interview, defend, etc.
4. Four Checkpoints. One Final Defense. Per grade-year.

One promise.

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Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

For educational and operational use. This document is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment is cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).